Week 3 Assignment: Jargon-to-Plain-English Clinic

Name:
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Passage 1: Rewrite

Currently, our top priority is fixing the client's login bug before Friday. The bug is obstructing three other tasks, so we should address it without delay. Because the client is unhappy, we must use our full team availability this week. We have already tried two quick fixes, but neither one worked. Tomorrow morning, the whole team will gather briefly to agree on the next steps. This is supposed to be a simple task, but we keep discovering new problems. When we find the root cause, we plan to examine the server logs closely together. After that, we will report back to the client and begin the next update without delay. Please reply with your progress by 5 p.m. today. If we stay coordinated and act fast, we can close this ticket by tomorrow.

Soon, we plan to fix two more small bugs in the same module. The second bug seems like a simple task, so it should not take long to fix. At the moment, we still do not know why the server keeps crashing every night. The new intern offered to take responsibility for this bug while the senior developer is on leave. Tomorrow morning, another engineer will log into the system to check the crash logs. We hope these small fixes will make a noticeable difference to the number of daily crashes. The client has asked for practical explanations of why this keeps happening. Our aim is to improve the entire server setup, not just patch one small part of it. This extra work is also an added benefit for the client, since it may prevent future problems. We should finish it in good time and keep everyone informed.

The team finally found the real cause of the crash late last night. We are writing a permanent fix instead of another quick patch. Ordinarily, we test every fix twice before sending it to the client. Because this bug affected several clients, we plan to test even more carefully this time. We will monitor the new server for one full day before we call it stable. After that, the team will carry on with the deployment to all remaining clients. This fix covers all of our core deliverables for this sprint, not just the login page. Our manager called it a complete solution and a big improvement for the support team. The new system handles growth better and runs on a more reliable framework than the old one. This fix should lift our whole product to a higher level, and the team is ready to start the next project without delay.

Passage 1: Glossary

Original	Plain English	Why
at this point in time / at this juncture	currently / at the moment	wordy phrase
creating a bottleneck for	obstructing	cliché
look after this issue	address	wrong phrasal verb ("look after" means care for)
due to the fact that / on account of the fact that	because	wordy phrase
leverage our full team bandwidth	use our full team availability	jargon
it is important to note that / it should be noted that	(deleted)	filler
touch base and get on the same page	gather briefly to agree	cliché
for all intents and purposes	(deleted)	filler

Original	Plain English	Why
deep dive into	examine closely	jargon
circle back with	report back to	jargon
hit the ground running	begin without delay	cliché
revert back to me	reply	misused ("revert" means return to a previous state) and redundant
in the near future	soon	wordy phrase
low-hanging fruit	simple task	cliché
take after this bug	take responsibility for	wrong phrasal verb ("take after" means resemble)
enter into the system	log into the system	wrong phrasal verb
move the needle	make a noticeable difference to	cliché
with reference to the above	(deleted)	filler
actionable insights	practical explanations	jargon
optimize the whole server ecosystem	improve the entire server setup	jargon
value-add	added benefit	jargon
in a timely manner	in good time	wordy phrase
in the process of writing	writing	wordy phrase
as a general rule	ordinarily	wordy phrase
put up with	monitor	wrong phrasal verb ("put up with" means tolerate)
continue on with	carry on with	redundant
end-to-end solution	complete solution	jargon
game-changer	big improvement	cliché
scalable / robust	handles growth / reliable	jargon
take to the next-level	lift	cliché

Passage 2: Rewrite

Our team held its annual planning meeting to discuss this year's plan. Our main goal is to coordinate better with the marketing department. Because the last product launch was slow, we must do much better this time. We agreed on five new action items and shared them with all the main people involved. Concerning hiring, we should check with the HR team before posting any new job. Everyone agreed to think creatively and try a few new marketing ideas this quarter. However, we should not depend on a single idea by spending our full budget on it. Next, the design team will examine customer feedback and our main strengths. We should reduce our travel costs so that we can spend more on this project. If everyone keeps thinking creatively and stops depending on a single idea, this plan can succeed.

Afterwards, the whole team met again to review our new marketing roadmap. At that point, everyone agreed that we needed a mindset open to growth. Our manager called this a small shift in thinking for the whole marketing team. Let's review the budget numbers together before we plan the next campaign. From now on, we also want more support from the sales department. A multi-department team will work faster than one department alone. We should increase our social media budget a little to support this new plan. Everyone agreed on one clear main aim for this quarter: more repeat customers. The whole team is trying to think creatively while planning these new campaigns.

Regarding sales, the new plan already looks promising after just two weeks. We found one early gain already: a simple change to our email subject lines. Overall, the value we offer customers needed to be clearer than before. Because our old website was slow, we lost several new customers last month. The design team studied a few good practices from other companies in our field. Sadly, two members decided to leave the project team this month. Largely, the client understood why we had to delay the product launch by two weeks. Our head of marketing now wants more expert-led articles on our blog and social pages. Talking to real customers helped us understand their difficulties and reach new cities. This project taught us again not to depend on a single idea.

Passage 2: Glossary

Original	Plain English	Why
at the present moment in time / at that particular point in time	now / at that point	wordy phrase
annual alignment meeting	annual planning meeting	vague jargon
needless to say / it goes without saying	(deleted)	filler
synergize better with	coordinate better with	jargon
in light of the fact that / by virtue of the fact that	because	wordy phrase
take it to the next level	do much better	cliché
key stakeholders	all the main people involved	jargon
with regard to the matter of	concerning	wordy phrase
look up to the HR team	check with	wrong phrasal verb ("look up to" means admire)
think outside the box	think creatively	cliché
put all our eggs in one basket	depend on a single idea	cliché
drill down into	examine	jargon
core competencies	main strengths	jargon
lower down / raise up	reduce / increase	redundant

Original	Plain English	Why
in due course	afterwards	wordy phrase
growth mindset	mindset open to growth	jargon
paradigm shift	small shift in thinking	jargon
get over the budget numbers	review	wrong phrasal verb ("get over" means recover from)
on a going-forward basis	from now on	wordy phrase
buy-in	support	jargon
cross-functional team	multi-department team	jargon
north star	main aim	cliché
as far as sales are concerned	regarding sales	wordy phrase
quick win	early gain	jargon
in the final analysis / for the most part	overall / largely	wordy phrase
value proposition	value we offer customers	jargon
best practices	good practices	jargon
exit out of	leave	redundant
call on the product launch	delay the product launch	wrong phrasal verb ("call on" means visit or ask)
thought leadership content	expert-led articles	jargon
pain points	difficulties	jargon
grow our footprint	reach new cities	cliché

Passage 3: Rewrite

Your report shows good effort, but a few sections still need work. If you have time before Friday, please add more practical comments for the sales team. To make this clear, please explain your data in closer detail in section three. As noted earlier, the client wants us to make the entire onboarding process simpler. Please double-check these figures, since two of the numbers do not match the original file. We also expect extra value in your final recommendations, not just a summary of the data. Try to take a wider view and think about all points of customer contact, not just the sales numbers. Our team regularly reviews these reports together before sending them to the client. Please send the corrected file back to me by Monday morning. The next step is with you now, and this report reflects your own hard work. Let's discuss it again tomorrow.

Please send the revised report as soon as you are able, ideally before Wednesday. To be sure the numbers are correct, please check them one more time. Could you read over the introduction once more before you send it back to me? Regarding the third section, try to compare our results against a clear point of comparison. Since this report will go to senior management, please keep the key takeaways short and clear. A data-based approach in section two will also make your argument stronger. Try to make your final chart look more professional and top-quality. Please join the two small tables into one, since they show similar numbers. Make your suggestions more practical, so the team knows exactly what to do next. A few small changes will polish your report and make it much stronger.

Your revised report is much clearer than the first draft. Usually, small changes like these make a big difference to the reader. Please check the conclusion again and read the last two sentences carefully. Your new chart is much more striking than the old one. Your writing also feels more audience-focused now, since you explain things from the client's point of view. Overall, this report shows that you can improve quickly based on feedback. Please add up all the final numbers before you send this to the client. Your recommendations are now more focused on value and results than before. This report also shows a clearer strategic direction for the whole project. The next step is with you one last time, so please send the final file by tomorrow.

Passage 3: Glossary

Original	Plain English	Why
at the end of the day	(deleted)	cliché filler
in the event that	if	wordy phrase
actionable feedback / actionable	practical comments / practical	jargon
for the purpose of clarity	to make this clear	wordy phrase
more granular level	closer detail	jargon
as previously mentioned above	as noted earlier	redundant
streamline	make simpler	jargon
check up these figures	double-check these figures	wrong phrasal verb ("check up" needs "on")
value addition	extra value	jargon
holistic approach	wider view	jargon
customer touchpoints	all points of customer contact	jargon
on a regular basis	regularly	wordy phrase
return back	send back	redundant
the ball is in your court	the next step is with you	cliché

Original	Plain English	Why
at your earliest convenience	as soon as you are able	wordy phrase
in order to ensure	to be sure	wordy phrase
go off the introduction	read over the introduction	wrong phrasal verb ("go off" means explode or leave)
with respect to	regarding	wordy phrase
owing to the fact that	since	wordy phrase
benchmark	clear point of comparison	jargon
data-driven approach	data-based approach	jargon
best-in-class	top-quality	jargon
combine together	join	redundant
as things currently stand	(deleted)	wordy phrase
in the majority of cases	usually	wordy phrase
look for the conclusion	check the conclusion again	wrong phrasal verb ("look for" means search for)
it is worth mentioning that	(deleted)	filler
impactful	much more striking	vague jargon
user-centric	audience-focused	jargon
on the whole	overall	wordy phrase
iterate	improve	jargon
add up together	add up	redundant
value-driven and results-oriented	focused on value and results	jargon

Passage 4: Rewrite

India's AI conversation has mostly revolved around large enterprises and the largest cloud companies running large language models (LLMs) on cloud-based infrastructure. But a far bigger opportunity lies in the country's more than 60 million small and medium businesses (SMBs). Together, these firms contribute nearly a third of India's GDP and make up the backbone of the economy. Despite this scale, AI adoption among SMBs remains limited, held back by scattered IT infrastructure, a weak ability to connect software through APIs (the links that let programs share data), and the belief that advanced AI is only for organisations with deep pockets and dedicated data science teams.

Tata Communications and Tata Tele-Business Services (TTBS) now aim to close this gap. Rather than launching another stand-alone application, the two companies are presenting their collaboration as one shared platform used by many businesses. Built on flexible cloud computing and edge connectivity (computing and networks near the user), it seeks to make enterprise-grade AI infrastructure more affordable and accessible to smaller businesses so that they can grow efficiently.

For many SMBs, the issue has never been recognising AI's potential. It has been handling deployment, since businesses often have to work with several vendors for network connections, cloud infrastructure, data-sovereignty compliance and customer engagement tools. Integration costs, delays and the need for specialised technical skills often outweigh the perceived benefits, slowing adoption.

The first visible result of the partnership is an AI-powered Voice Agent platform, hosted on a dedicated AI cloud and powered by the companies' own conversational AI engine. It lets businesses deploy agents that understand natural language and can handle enquiries, schedule appointments and process orders easily. Unlike older interactive voice response (IVR) systems, these agents convert speech into text and text into speech to talk naturally with customers, and they are available round the clock without any human involvement.

Finally, executives describe the partnership as a rare, major breakthrough, arguing that access to robust network infrastructure and fast computing may soon matter as much as access to the AI models themselves. Whether this vision comes true will depend on execution, affordability, and how quickly SMBs feel comfortable trusting new digital technology.

Passage 4: Glossary

Original	Plain English	Why
for the most part	mostly	wordy phrase
hyperscalers	the largest cloud companies	jargon
cloud-native infrastructure	cloud-based infrastructure	jargon
bigger and greater / more than over	far bigger / more than	redundant
lie / contributes / comprises	lies / contribute / make up	grammar and word choice ("comprises" is misused here)
fragmented IT infrastructure	scattered IT infrastructure	jargon
API integration capabilities	ability to connect software through APIs (the links that let programs share data)	jargon, explained
looking forward to close	now aim to close	wrong phrasal verb and grammar
multi-tenant	one shared platform used by many businesses	technical jargon

Original	Plain English	Why
scalable, edge connectivity	flexible cloud computing and edge connectivity (computing and networks near the user)	jargon
to grow and to scale efficiently and effectively	grow efficiently	redundant
conundrum	issue	unnecessary formal word
recognising and identifying	recognising	redundant
deployment orchestration	handling deployment	jargon
traverse multiple different vendors	work with several vendors	wordy
connectivity provisioning	network connections	jargon
latency issues	delays	jargon
really specialised / almost frequently	specialised / often	redundant, wrong adverb
outcome and result	result	redundant
proprietary conversational AI engine	the companies' own conversational AI engine	jargon
capable of and able to handle	can handle	redundant
with relative ease and without much difficulty	easily	redundant
leverage speech-to-text and text-to-speech pipelines and processes	convert speech into text and text into speech	jargon, redundant
around the clock, 24 hours a day / without human intervention whatsoever	round the clock / without any human involvement	redundant
in the end	finally	wordy phrase
game-changer that happens once in a blue moon	rare, major breakthrough	mixed clichés
low-latency compute / model architectures	fast computing / AI models	jargon
materialises off	comes true	wrong phrasal verb
putting their trust up into	trusting	wrong phrasal verb
digital transformation technology	new digital technology	jargon

Passage 5: Rewrite

A Chinese startup called Linkerbot is working to solve one of robotics' hardest problems: dexterous robotic hands with many independently moving joints. Founded in 2023 by CEO Alex Zhou, the Beijing-based company builds five-fingered robotic hands with touch sensors and motors that let humanoid robots grasp objects, tighten screws and, eventually, take on household chores like cooking and cleaning.

Replicating the human hand, with its fine control, adaptable grip strength and sensory feedback, is a huge task, industry insiders say. Even Tesla's Optimus struggles with hand dexterity, although its legs work fine. Zhou believes that combining artificial intelligence with China's manufacturing strength will close this technology gap for good.

Linkerbot has raised a large amount of funding, closing a Series B+ round in April that valued it at $3 billion, a remarkable sum for such a young company. Zhou is now seeking a $6 billion valuation, which would make him a billionaire almost overnight, and investors are queuing up to take part.

The company's competitive advantage is low cost, because Linkerbot makes almost all of its components in-house. From motor assembly to sensor calibration, it can undercut rivals such as Singapore's Sharpa and London's Shadow Robot by a wide margin. Zhou insists that economies of scale will bring the hardware cost down to under $100 per pair within three years, a price that would sharply undercut rivals.

Analysts warn, however, that the robotic-hands sector could slide into a race to the bottom, called "involution" in China, as competitors cut prices to remain in the market. Some fear the industry could overextend itself, mass-producing hands faster than the underlying AI and motor technology can keep up. Whether Linkerbot can stay afloat while scaling to 100,000 units a year and improving the number of independent joint movements its hands manage remains to be seen.

Passage 5: Glossary

Original	Plain English	Why
are cooking up a solution	is working to solve	cliché and grammar
biggest headaches	hardest problems	cliché
multi-degree-of-freedom	with many independently moving joints	jargon
actuator motors	motors	jargon
reverse-engineering	replicating	jargon
herculean task	huge task	cliché
reckons	believes	informal
manufacturing muscle	manufacturing strength	cliché
once and for all	for good	cliché
massive amounts of capital	a large amount of funding	jargon
eye-watering sum	remarkable sum	cliché
overnight, so to speak	almost overnight	filler
lining out to put in on the action	queuing up to take part	wrong phrasal verbs
competitive hedge, redundantly speaking	competitive advantage	wrong word ("hedge" means protection) and filler
nearly almost all	almost all	redundant
vertically integrates ... in-house	makes ... in-house	jargon

Original	Plain English	Why
bring downwards ... down	bring down	redundant
bill of materials	hardware cost	jargon
benchmark / undercut off	price / undercut	jargon, wrong phrasal verb
race to the bottom	kept and explained	idiom, clarified
stay put in the game	remain in the market	wrong phrasal verb and cliché
biting off more than it can swallow	overextend	garbled idiom
keep on up with	keep up	wrong phrasal verb
keep its head above the water	stay afloat	garbled idiom
degrees-of-freedom benchmarks	number of independent joint movements	jargon
remains to be saw	remains to be seen	grammar